

Indiana Esports Network

Mario Kart 8 Deluxe

Competition Ruleset

2026-2027

Competition Status:

Varsity / Club

Competition Format:

Team-Based

Platform:

Nintendo Switch or Switch 2

Ruleset Version:

1.01

Effective Date:

9/10/26



Document Information

Information	Details
Game Title	Mario Kart 8 Deluxe
Publisher	Nintendo
Season	2026-2027
Competition Level	Varsity / Club
Version	4.0.0
Effective Date	8/3/26

Quick Reference

This section provides a summary of the most important competition information.

Category	Information
Competition Type	Team
Platform	Nintendo Switch or Switch 2
Team Size	4
Maximum Roster	6
Match Format	4v4 Team Races, 150cc, Best-of-Three (Bo3) Sets during Regular Season
Match Length	Up to 3 Sets per Match; each Set consists of 4 Races (1 Grand Prix)
Scoring System	Team scores are totaled across all 4 races in a set. The team with the higher total score wins the set. First team to win 2 sets wins the match.
Playoff Format	Single-Elimination Bracket seeded by regular season standings. All varsity teams qualify for playoffs.
Championship Format	Best-of-Five (Bo5) Sets. First team to win 3 sets is crowned IEN State Champion. Match ends once a team reaches 3 set wins.

Coach Checklist

Before the Season

- ☐ Register team/player information with IEN
 - ☐ Verify student eligibility
 - ☐ Review competition rules
 - ☐ Confirm required equipment
 - ☐ Ensure players have approved accounts
 - ☐ Review schedule and deadlines
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Before Each Match

- ☐ Confirm roster availability
 - ☐ Update game software
 - ☐ Verify settings
 - ☐ Confirm opponent communication
 - ☐ Prepare required equipment
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1. Competition Overview

1.1 Purpose

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) establishes this ruleset to define the official competition standards for **Mario Kart 8 Deluxe**.

This document provides the information required for schools, coaches, and students to participate in IEN competition.

All participants must also follow the requirements established in the current IEN Member Handbook.

1.2 Competition Model

Competition Type:

- ☐ Team-Based

Description:

Schools compete in **4v4 team-based Mario Kart 8 Deluxe competition**, racing in a series of pre-assigned Grand Prix cups throughout the season. Each match consists of multiple sets, with

each set containing four races. Team scores are accumulated across all races in a set, and the team with the higher total score wins the set. During the regular season, teams compete in Best-of-Three (Bo3) matches to earn standings points and qualify for the postseason. Varsity teams advance to a seeded single-elimination playoff bracket, culminating in a Best-of-Five (Bo5) championship match to determine the IEN State Champion.

2. Team and Player Structure

2.1 Roster Information

Requirement	Details
Minimum Roster	5
Maximum Roster	6
Active Players	5
Substitutes	2



2.2 Coaches

Coach requirements:

All coach eligibility, supervision, and participation requirements are governed by the IEN Bylaws and General Competition Rules.



3. Match Format

3.1 Competition Format

Mario Kart 8 Deluxe competition is conducted as a **4v4 team-based series** in which schools compete across multiple sets of races using pre-assigned Grand Prix cups. Each set consists of **four races played on four designated tracks**. Player points earned during each race are combined to produce a team score, and the team with the higher total score at the end of the four races wins the set.

During the **regular season**, matches are played as a **Best-of-Three (Bo3)** series. The first team to win **two sets** wins the match. If a team wins the first two sets, the third set is not played. Teams compete weekly against other schools and earn standings points based on match results.

Each week features a **pre-assigned Grand Prix cup**, ensuring all participating schools compete on the same set of tracks. Teams may substitute players between sets but not during an active set. Match scores are reported through LeagueOS, and screenshots of race results are recommended for verification and dispute resolution.

At the conclusion of the regular season, teams are seeded into a **single-elimination playoff bracket** based on regular season standings. Playoff winners advance until the championship match. The State Championship is played as a **Best-of-Five (Bo5)** series, with the first team to win **three sets** being crowned the IEN State Champion.

3.2 Match Structure

Category	Details
Match Type	4v4 Team Races, 150cc, Best-of-Three (Bo3) Sets during the Regular Season; Best-of-Five (Bo5) Sets for the State Championship.
Games Per Match	Up to 3 Sets in Regular Season matches. Each Set consists of 4 races (1 Grand Prix), for a maximum of 12 races if all three sets are played.
Victory Condition	Win the majority of sets. The first team to win 2 sets wins a regular season match. In the championship match, the first team to win 3 sets is declared the State Champion.

3.3 Tie Procedures

If a tie occurs:

If a set ends with both teams earning the same total points after all four races, the set is considered tied. During regular season Best-of-Three matches, if the series reaches a third set

and that set ends in a tie, the match shall be recorded as a tie. Additional tiebreak procedures for playoff advancement may be established by tournament administration as necessary.

4. Competition Schedule

4.1 Regular Season

Season dates: High School

Preseason 10/15/26-10/29/26

Regular Season 11/5/26-12/10/26

Winter Break 12/11/26-1/3/27

Regular Season (continue) 1/7/26 - 2/11/27

Playoffs 2/25/27 - 3/18/27

Finals 4/24/27



5. Official Game Settings

5.1 Required Settings

IEN competitions will use:

Setting	Configuration
Game Style	150cc Race
Teams	Team Game (4v4)
Items	Normal Items
COM Rac	Off / No COM
Vehicles	All Vehicles Permitted
Race Count	Four races per set (one Grand Prix)

Team Size	4 Players vs. 4 Players
Platform	Mario Kart 8 Deluxe on Nintendo Switch consoles
Track Selection	Weekly pre-assigned Grand Prix cup; tracks must be played in order

5.2 Approved Maps / Arenas / Courses / Stages

Week	Cup
Preseason Week 1	Crossing Cup
Preseason Week 2	Star Cup
1	Mushroom Cup
2	Flower Cup
3	Star Cup
4	Special Cup
5	Shell Cup
6	Banana Cup
7 (HS only)	Leaf Cup
8 (HS only)	Lightning Cup
9 (HS only)	Egg Cup
10 (HS only)	Triforce Cup
Playoffs Week 1	Turnip Cup (DLC)
Playoffs Week 2	Lucky Cat Cup (DLC)
Playoffs Week 3	Rock Cup (DLC)
Playoffs Week 4	Fruit Cup (DLC)

5.3 Restricted Content

The following are not permitted:

- Use of unauthorized modifications, cheats, exploits, hacks, or third-party software that alters gameplay or provides a competitive advantage. Participation must take place using the official retail version of Mario Kart 8 Deluxe.
- Use of settings, lobby configurations, or game rules that differ from the official IEN-required match settings, including unauthorized race formats, item settings, COM racers, or track selections.
- Changing the required weekly cup or playing tracks out of the prescribed order without authorization from league officials.
- Spectator participation that interferes with competition. Streamers may not act as spectators during an official match.

6. Document History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	8/3/26	Initial Release
1.01	9/10/26	Removed extra weeks in season

